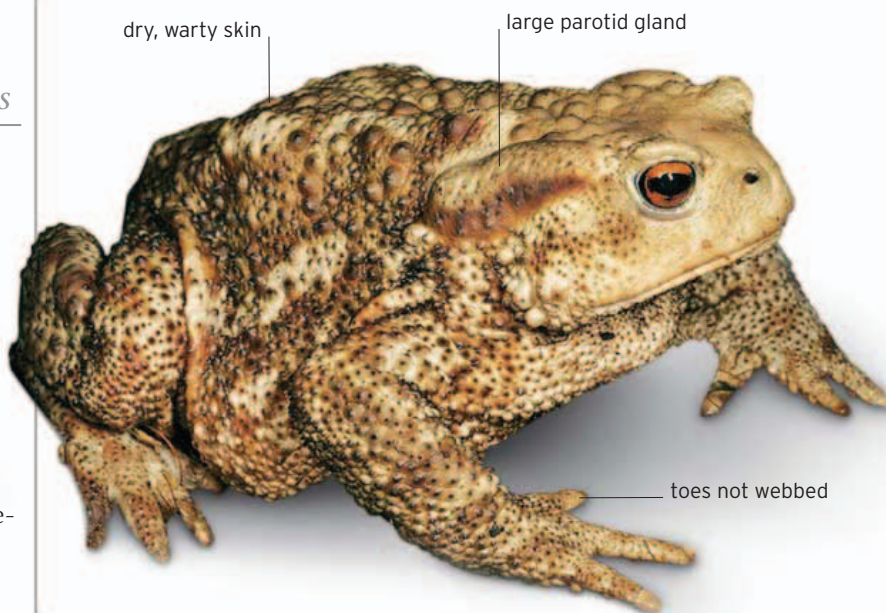


South American bullfrog

Leptodactylus pentadactylus

- ↔ 3–9 in (8–23 cm)
- 📍 N. South America
- ⊗ Common

Males of this large rainforest frog have spines on their chest and thumbs for fighting rivals. In its humid habitat, the species is adapted for laying eggs on land. While mating, a male and female whip watery mucus into a froth using their hindlegs. Fertilized eggs are deposited in this “bubble-nest.” Eggs hatch during rainfall, and larvae get washed into pools to complete their development.



European common toad

Bufo bufo

- ↔ 3–8 in (8–20 cm)
- 📍 NW. Africa, Europe to C. Asia
- ⊗ Common

This species belongs to a family of true toads, characterised by warty skin and two large glands behind the eyes; these release a toxic secretion that deters predators. Southern populations—regarded by some scientists as a separate species—have spiny warts for extra protection. This toad breeds in ponds, laying its eggs in “strings” of jelly that become entwined around water weeds.

Cane toad

Rhinella marina

- ↔ 2–9 in (5–23 cm)
- 📍 Central America, South America; introduced to Australia and elsewhere
- ⊗ Common

Originally from South America (where it is known as the marine toad), one of the world’s biggest toads has spread far and wide. It was introduced to control insect pests of sugarcane, but its voracious predatory habits and toxic skin have proved harmful to vulnerable wildlife. It lays clutches of up to 20,000 eggs in ponds.

Darwin’s frog

Rhinoderma darwinii

- ↔ 1 in (2.5 cm)
- 📍 S. South America
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Restricted to the cool, wet rainforests of southern Chile and Argentina, this pointed-nose frog resembles a dead leaf, which camouflages it against forest leaf litter. The female lays eggs on the moist forest floor. The attending father takes them into his vocal pouch—where they continue their development. Hatching froglets jump out of their father’s mouth.

Paradoxical frog

Pseudis paradoxa

- ↔ 2–3 in (5–8 cm)
- 📍 N. and C. South America
- ⊗ Common

This highly aquatic frog spawns in floating foam nests. The eggs have abundant yolk, which can sustain the tadpoles for weeks. If other food is available, they grow more quickly, reaching up to 10 in (25 cm) in length—the largest of any frog. During metamorphosis, their long tail is reabsorbed, so the fully developed frog is just a quarter of the tadpole’s maximum length.

Spring peeper

Pseudacris crucifer

- ↔ $\frac{3}{4}$ –2 in (2–5 cm)
- 📍 SE. Canada, E. US
- ⊗ Common

The scientific name “*crucifer*” refers to the crosslike pattern on the back of the peeper. It belongs to a group of highly vocal frogs called “chorus frogs.” The peeper retires under logs to hibernate during winter, even tolerating partial freezing in the northernmost reach of its range. When it stirs from dormancy, its high-pitched “peeping” call is a sign that spring has arrived.



Common tree frog

Hyla arborea

- ↔ 1–2 in (2.5–5 cm)
- 📍 W. Europe, Asia
- ⊗ Common

True tree frogs make up a large family that have their greatest diversity in the tropical Americas—but this is a member of a small species group from Eurasia. Like its cousins, its eyes have horizontal pupils and its toes are tipped with small disks to help with climbing trees. The skin color varies from green to yellow or brown over its wide geographic range. During the breeding season, males make loud quacking sounds building up into a noisy chorus.

European common frog

Rana temporaria

- ↔ 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
- 📍 Europe, NW. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Familiar in northern Europe as the archetypal frog, the distribution of this species reaches inside the Arctic Circle. The European common frog is common in wetlands and backyards across its range—and sometimes overwinters by hibernating in mud under water. Arctic frogs survive the bitter winter by staying inactive under the cover of tundra ice. In springtime, large numbers of this species gather in ponds to breed.